



FREE STARTER GUIDE

Build It to Bloom

A free starter guide to organizing your business

BUILD & BLOOM COLLECTIVE

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Start here

You do not need a perfect plan to start. You need a clear offer, a few simple systems, and a pace you can keep.

This guide is for you if you are starting a business, or if you are already running one and it all lives in your head. It walks through five steps and ends with a 30-day plan. Work through it with a pen. Each step has questions to answer and boxes to check.

One note before you begin: this guide is general education. For legal, tax, and licensing decisions, talk with a qualified professional in your state.

Step 1: Get clear

Clarity comes before structure. If you cannot say what you do in two sentences, no system will fix it.

ANSWER THESE IN WRITING

- What problem do I solve, and for whom?

- What changes for them after working with me?

- What do I want this business to give me: income, time, impact, or all three? In what order?

- What am I not willing to trade for it?

WRITE YOUR ONE-LINE OFFER

I help [who] to [result] through [how].

THEN CHECK IT

- ☐ A stranger could repeat it back to me

- ☐ It names one kind of person, not everyone
- ☐ It names a result, not a list of tasks
- ☐ I can deliver it without burning out

Step 2: Make it official

Getting set up properly protects you and makes you easier to hire. Requirements differ by state and by type of work, so confirm each item for your situation.

- ☐ Choose a business name and check that it is available
- ☐ Decide on a business structure with a professional's advice
- ☐ Register the business with your state if your structure requires it
- ☐ Get a federal tax ID if you need one
- ☐ Check which local licenses or permits apply to your work
- ☐ Look into insurance that fits what you do
- ☐ Claim your domain name and social handles
- ☐ Set up a business email address
- ☐ Draft a simple service agreement and have it reviewed

Keep one folder for every registration, license, and agreement. Future you will thank you.

Step 3: Organize your money

You cannot protect your peace if you do not know your numbers. Keep this simple enough that you will actually do it.

- ☐ Open a bank account used only for the business
- ☐ Pick one way to send invoices and take payments
- ☐ Track every dollar in and out, weekly
- ☐ Set aside part of every payment for taxes, and ask a tax professional how much
- ☐ Decide what you will pay yourself, and when

PRICE FOR SUSTAINABILITY

Work through these three questions before you set a price:

1. What does it cost me to deliver this, in money and in hours?

2. How many clients can I serve well in a month, not just survive?

3. At that number, does my price cover the business and pay me?

If the answer to the third question is no, the price is too low or the offer is too big.

A 15-MINUTE WEEKLY MONEY CHECK

- What came in?

- What went out?

- Who owes me, and who do I owe?

- What is coming due in the next 30 days?

Step 4: Organize your operations

Operations is how the work actually gets done. When it lives only in your head, every task costs more energy than it should.

MAP ONE CLIENT FROM START TO FINISH

Write down each step a client goes through with you:

1. How they find you
2. How they ask to work with you
3. How you say yes and get paid
4. How you start the work
5. How you deliver it
6. How you close it out and ask for a referral

Circle the step where things get stuck most often. Fix that one first.

WRITE DOWN THREE PROCESSES

Pick the three things you do most often. For each, write the steps in a short numbered list. That is your first standard operating procedure.

CHOOSE YOUR TOOLS, ONE PER JOB

JOB	WHAT YOU NEED
Scheduling	One calendar and one booking link
Files	One shared folder with clear names
Tasks	One list you check every day
Communication	One main channel for clients
Money	One place for invoices and tracking

- ☐ I have one tool for each job, not three
- ☐ My files follow one naming pattern
- ☐ My three most common processes are written down

Step 5: Protect your capacity

A business that depends on you running empty is not built to last. Capacity is part of the plan, not a reward for finishing it.

KNOW YOUR REAL NUMBER

- How many hours a week can I work and still be well?

- How many of those hours are client work, and how many are admin?

- What is the most clients I can serve at that pace?

SET YOUR BOUNDARIES BEFORE YOU NEED THEM

- ☐ My working hours are written down and shared with clients
- ☐ I have a set response time for messages
- ☐ I have one day or block each week with no meetings
- ☐ I know what I will say no to this season

BUILD IN RECOVERY

- A short reset between demanding sessions
- A weekly review to close open loops
- One thing each week that has nothing to do with work

If you lead a team, ask the same questions about them. The way the work is set up is either supporting your people or wearing them down.

Your first 30 days

One focus per week. Small, finished steps beat a big unfinished plan.

WEEK	FOCUS	FINISH THESE
1	Get clear	Answer the Step 1 questions. Write your one-line offer. Say it to three people.
2	Make it official and set up money	Work the Step 2 checklist. Open your business account. Choose how you take payments.
3	Organize operations	Map one client from start to finish. Write down three processes. Choose one tool per job.
4	Protect capacity and launch	Set your hours and boundaries. Price your offer. Tell your network what you do.

AT THE END OF 30 DAYS, ASK

- What is working that I should keep?

- What is still living only in my head?

- Where do I need help?

Your next step with Build & Bloom

If you want a partner for the parts that feel heavy, that is what Build & Bloom Collective does.

- **Offer & Pricing Design Session.** Clarify what you sell, who it serves, and how it is priced so it sustains you.
- **Strategy Intensive.** A focused 90-minute working session on one priority: a launch, a pivot, or a stuck decision.
- **SOP & Systems Documentation Build.** We document how your work actually runs so it can grow past one person.
- **Strategy & Capacity Consulting.** Ongoing support for clarity, structure, and sustainable growth.

Reach out through the contact form on our website, or find us on Instagram at [@buildbloom.co](#).

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